

Audit Evidence Retention Policy

Retention and retrieval

OWNER	Security & GRC
EFFECTIVE	2026-07-13
REVIEW CYCLE	Annual or material change
CLASSIFICATION	Internal

1. Purpose and scope

This policy establishes how Cobalt Harbor Systems ensures that audit evidence remains complete, protected, and retrievable through its retention period. It applies to personnel and approved providers performing the governed activity.

2. Control objectives

Objective A. Establish accountable, repeatable operating decisions for retention and retrieval.

Objective B. Produce evidence that supports independent assurance and timely remediation.

3. Required operating practices

1. Plan the activity with documented scope, owner, and timing appropriate to retention and retrieval.
2. Execute and record the activity using the required evidence attributes: retention class, repository, access list, legal hold, and disposal authorization.
3. Review exceptions and changes before they affect the control conclusion.
4. Preserve decisions and evidence in the approved repository for the stated retention period.

4. Accountability

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Record owner	Carries the assigned decision, review, or recordkeeping responsibility.
Records manager	Carries the assigned decision, review, or recordkeeping responsibility.
Internal Audit	Carries the assigned decision, review, or recordkeeping responsibility.

Retention and retrieval: assurance criteria

5. Evidence standard

The accountable owner retains evidence that is sufficient to demonstrate the operating result. At minimum, each record includes: retention class, repository, access list, legal hold, and disposal authorization. Evidence is linked to the applicable system, review period, owner, and disposition so another qualified reviewer can reproduce the conclusion.

6. Measurement and reporting

MEASURE	OPERATING THRESHOLD
Primary metric	Retrieval tests achieve 95% completion within two business days
Quality review	Evidence completeness and sampled accuracy are reviewed monthly.
Management reporting	Trends, overdue actions, and material exceptions are reported to Security & GRC.

7. Noncompliance and escalation

Destruction holds override scheduled disposal until released by Legal The responsible owner documents the correction, root cause, and follow-up verification. Material deviations are included in the assurance register until closure.

8. Revision and approval

The policy owner reviews this policy annually, after a material control change, or following an assurance finding related to retention and retrieval. Revisions must identify changed obligations, affected owners, and implementation timing before approval.

APPROVER	ROLE	STATUS
Mira Patel	Director, Security & GRC	Approved
Jonah Reed	Control Assurance Lead	Reviewed